

NVIDIA Corporation

Financing structure diffuses risk, extends runway, cements lead

Maintain Rating: BUY | PO: 350.00 USD | Price: 217.55 USD

NVDA underwrites the value, not the loan

NVDA signed MOUs with six top financiers — Apollo, BlackRock, Blackstone, Brookfield, Goldman Sachs and KKR — to mobilize \$500bn+ of third-party capital via independent platforms. We await further details, but **our first take is a positive one – the burden sits with the consortium, not NVDA's balance sheet.** This appears to be a pivot away from vendor-financing (i.e. OpenAI initial \$100bn, ~\$250bn guarantee) that drew circularity fire – which we estimate at only ~15% of ~\$470bn FCF over the next two years (CY26-27) (see Exhibit 1). NVDA's upcoming earnings call could provide critically needed assurance on its go-forward role in vendor financing, so that FCF can be better directed to a stock that trades at significantly depressed valuation, in our view. We note current consensus models buybacks at ~\$73bn/\$106bn for CY26/27, or just ~36-37% of FCF vs. NVDA's >50% return pledge.

NVDA GPUs offer long-term performance assurance

For \$500bn of capital to treat compute as an “investable asset class,” residual value must hold — and that is exactly what NVDA supplies. **Compute that is fungible and transferable across operators**, with CUDA continuously extending useful life, keeps resell/rental rates high and depreciation curves benign. NVDA guarantees asset quality, not the debt — turning the bear's depreciation worry into the enabling feature.

Extends the runway on the AI buildout

Funding, not demand, has been the bottleneck — every hyperscaler complains of being supply-constrained. A \$500bn pool (2.5x Google's network) lets non-investment grade (IG) buyers — labs, neoclouds, sovereigns — secure GPUs, power and data centers at attractive rates, de-risking offtake and supporting our \$1.7tn CY30 AI systems TAM path (see [related cloud capex here](#) and [AI TAM reports linked here](#)).

Key debates and risks we are watching

Some caveats remain: 1) third-party capital still needs real end-customers paying real money, and MOUs are not deployed capital; 2) transferring/diffusing risk does not mean every ROI question is answered; 3) power/regulatory blowback (cancelled UK NScale) and input-cost inflation persist; 4) new financing structures can add opacity/complexity to AI buildouts and pressure trading multiples; 5) while we assume this limits NVDA's further balance-sheet exposure, we await its exact role — any greater cash demands could constrain FCF available for much-needed buybacks to support the stock.

Reiterate Buy; NVDA top pick, \$320 PO

At <20x CY27E PE (~0.4x PEG vs. 46%+ EPS CAGR) and ~65-70% share of a \$1.7tn+ CY30 TAM, NVDA remains compelling. This platform cements the CUDA moat while shifting capital risk off NVDA — a structurally bullish setup in our view. Upcoming earnings call (Aug-26) the next important catalyst. The stock has come under pressure following the last 4/4 and 6/10 earnings, as expectations are elevated. However, we remain positive, as explained in our recent [Q2 preview](#) on potential with NVDA's next-gen Vera Rubin product cycle in further cementing the company's ~70% industry share.

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Stock Data

Price	217.55 USD
Price Objective	350.00 USD
Date Established	20-May-2026
Investment Opinion	C-1-7
52-Week Range	164.07 USD - 236.54 USD
Mkt Val (mn) / Shares Out (mn)	5,412,644 USD / 24,880.0
Free Float	96.2%
Average Daily Value (mn)	28924.40 USD
BofA Ticker / Exchange	NVDA / NAS
Bloomberg / Reuters	NVDA US / NVDA.OQ
ROE (2027E)	95.9%
Net Dbt to Eqty (Jan-2026A)	-1.4%

6G – Sixth-Gen Mobile Comms

AI – Artificial Intelligence

AI-RAN – Artificial Intelligence Radio Access Network

CPU – Central Processing Unit

CUDA – Compute Unified Device Architecture

EDA – Electronic Design Automation

GPU – Graphics Processing Unit

GPU – Graphics Processing Unit

IG – Investment Grade

IREN – IREN Limited

KKR – KKR & Co. Inc.

MOU – Memorandum of Understanding

NVDA – NVIDIA Corporation

ROI – Return on Investment

TAM – Total Addressable Market

Partner financing just ~15% of FCF

So far, we estimate NVDA has committed to directly providing **~\$70bn in equity investments** into ecosystem partners, including the recent \$30bn investment into OpenAI, up to \$10bn into Anthropic, and \$5bn into Ilya Sutskever's Safe Superintelligence.

This is on top of NVDA's **other customer backings** such as its \$1.5bn GPU sale-leaseback with Lambda, a program to rent back unused GPUs at fixed rates from neoclouds, and another \$860mn in lease obligations for an undisclosed partners.

Overall, we view NVDA's \$70bn investments as easily manageable given its ability to generate as much as ~\$470bn of FCF over just the next two years (CY26-27), **or ~15% of FCF**. In other words, we see no issue in NVDA returning 50% of FCF to shareholders as it has committed to in May 2026.

Exhibit 1: NVDA has committed ~\$70bn of total equity investments into partners vs. ~\$470bn of FCF throughout CY26-27E, representing ~15% of FCF

NVDA's major equity investment programs into ecosystem partners

Company Invested	Date	NVDA Investments	Bucket
OpenAI	Feb/Mar-26	\$30bn	Frontier model
Anthropic	Nov-25	Up to \$10bn	Frontier model
Safe Superintelligence	Jul-26	\$5bn	AI data-center infrastructure / power
Intel	Sep-25	\$5bn	CPU / x86 ecosystem
Synopsys	Dec-25	\$2bn	EDA / engineering software
Nokia	Oct-25	\$1bn	AI-RAN / 6G / networking
CoreWeave	Jan-26	\$2bn	Neocloud / AI infrastructure
Nebius	Mar-26	\$2bn	Neocloud / AI cloud
Lumentum	Mar-26	\$2bn	Photonics / lasers
Coherent	Mar-26	\$2bn	Photonics / optical networking
Marvell	Mar-26	\$2bn	Custom silicon / silicon photonics / networking
Corning	May-26	Up to \$3.2bn	Optical fiber / AI interconnect manufacturing
IREN	May-26	Up to \$2.1bn	AI data-center infrastructure / power
Wayve	Sep-25	Proposed \$500mn	Autonomous driving / embodied AI
Nscale	Sep-25	£500mn	UK AI infrastructure / neocloud
Ayar Labs	Mar-26	Unknown	Co-packaged optics
xAI	Jan-26	Unknown	Frontier model
Total Invested		~\$70bn	
NVDA FCF		\$469bn (CY26-27E)	

Source: BofA Global Research estimates, company data

BofA GLOBAL RESEARCH

Price objective basis & risk

NVIDIA Corporation (NVDA)

Our \$350 PO is based on 26x CY27E PE ex cash, within NVDA's historical 25x-56x forward year PE range, which we believe is justified by NVDA's leading share in fast-growing AI compute/networking markets, offset by lumpiness in global AI projects, cyclical gaming market, and concerns around access to power.

Downside risks are: 1) weakness in consumer driven gaming market, 2) Competition with major public firms, internal cloud projects and other private companies in AI and accelerated computing markets, 3) Larger than expected impact from restrictions on compute shipments to China, or additional restrictions placed on activity in the region, 4) Lumpy and unpredictable sales in new enterprise, data center, and autos markets, 5) Potential for decelerating capital returns, and 6) Enhanced government scrutiny of NVDA's dominant market position in AI chips.

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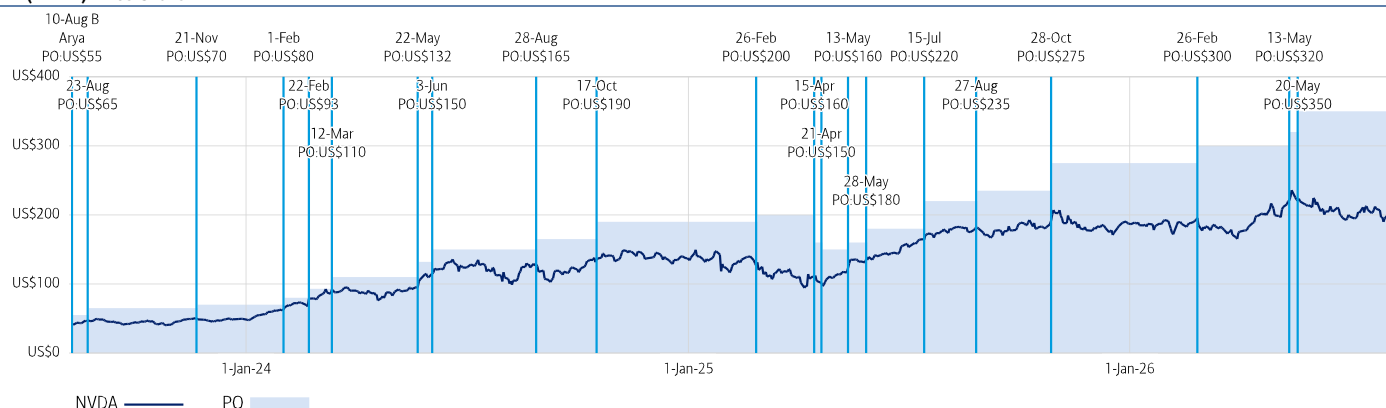
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NVIDIA (NVDA) Price Chart



B: Buy, N: Neutral, U: Underperform, PO: Price Objective, NA: No longer valid, NR: No Rating

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Coverage Universe	Count	Percent	Inv. Banking Relationships ^{R1}	Count	Percent
Buy	243	60.60%	Buy	123	50.62%
Hold	87	21.70%	Hold	45	51.72%
Sell	71	17.71%	Sell	21	29.58%

Equity Investment Rating Distribution: Global Group (as of 30 Jun 2026)

Coverage Universe	Count	Percent	Inv. Banking Relationships ^{R1}	Count	Percent
Buy	1987	56.11%	Buy	1190	59.89%
Hold	797	22.51%	Hold	496	62.23%
Sell	757	21.38%	Sell	391	51.65%

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Buy	≥ 10%	≤ 70%
Neutral	≥ 0%	≤ 30%
Underperform	N/A	≥ 20%

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